

DIGITALAIKART

The AI Study Playbook

Study smarter, not longer - with the free AI tools built for Indian students

Boards - College - JEE - NEET - CUET - UPSC - Banking - State PSC
22 chapters | 68 copy-paste prompts | 9 free tools decoded
Every fact verified from official sources - October 2026

India Edition

Digital Edition - Rs 99

Welcome

This playbook exists because of a gap that opened quietly over the last two years. Every student in India now has, free of charge, a study assistant that can read a whole textbook, explain any chapter in simple language, build flashcards, generate practice tests in the exact format of your exam, and quiz you until the topic sticks. A decade ago that package would have cost a family lakhs in tuition. Today it sits behind a Gmail login and a smartphone.

The gap is not access. The gap is knowing how to use these tools so they make you smarter instead of lazier. That is the entire job of this book.

Who this is for

Class 9 to 12 students preparing for boards. College students balancing coursework, internals and end-semesters. Competitive-exam aspirants working through JEE, NEET, CUET, UPSC, SSC, banking or state PSC syllabi. And any self-learner who wants to move faster without spending money.

What you will be able to do by the end

- Run a four-step study loop that uses AI for the hard part - practice and recall - while you keep doing the thinking.
- Set up one source-grounded notebook per subject so the AI answers from your own textbooks, not from guesswork.
- Write prompts that return exam-ready practice, not vague summaries, using one five-part formula.
- Study with the two techniques that research rates highest - practice testing and spaced review - at a speed that used to be impossible.
- Use AI for help without crossing the academic-integrity line, and know exactly where that line sits in India.

How to use this book

Read Parts 1 and 2 once, end to end - they set the ground rules and decode the free tools. Then treat Part 3 as your operating manual and Part 5 as a reference you return to daily. Every prompt in the library is written to be copied, pasted and edited in under a minute. Do not read the prompt library like a novel; open it when you sit down to study.

A note on honesty and accuracy

Every tool limit, price, date and platform fact in this book was checked against official sources - Google's own student pages and blog, the Gemini Notebook help centre, OpenAI's help centre, NCERT, DIKSHA, SWAYAM and the Press Information Bureau - in October 2026. AI products change fast, so the book tells you where to re-check any number before you rely on it. Where a figure comes from a single company's published data rather than a government source, the book says so.

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Quick start (if you only have ten minutes)

Go to Chapter 5, create one Gemini Notebook for your weakest subject, upload the chapter PDF and your class notes, and ask it for ten practice questions. Answer them without looking. That one loop - upload, generate, answer, check - is 80 per cent of this book.

PART 1

Why AI changes how you study

Before you open a single tool, you need the case for using AI at all - and the one rule that separates students it makes sharper from students it makes weaker.

In this part

- The 2026 reality for Indian students
- The outsourcing trap and how to avoid it
- The two techniques research rates highest
- Where the academic-integrity line sits

1. The study advantage hiding in plain sight

Indian students gained a genuinely new study tool in 2026, and most have not noticed. In July 2026 Google renamed its research assistant NotebookLM to Gemini Notebook. In August 2026 it began giving eligible Indian college students a full year of its paid Google AI Plus plan at no cost, redeemable until 31 December 2026. In September 2026 the University Grants Commission put out a draft that would make an AI-literacy module compulsory for every first-year undergraduate from the 2027-28 session. AI has moved from a novelty to something the system itself is starting to require.

The demand is already visible in what students search for

A published analysis of 18,774 real Indian student searches, logged from Google Search Console between April and October 2026, found that queries about AI prompts earned 98.2 clicks per thousand impressions - by far the highest-converting theme in the dataset, against a site average of 3.4. Queries like "free AI tools for students" and "best AI for students" ran into the hundreds. Students are not wondering whether to use these tools. They are hunting for the ones that work and the words that make them work. That is the single clearest demand signal in this book.

It is a career signal, not just a study trick

The same shift is happening in the job market. The Naukri JobSpeak index for September 2026, reported in early October, showed overall white-collar hiring up about 2 per cent year on year while fresher hiring crawled at roughly 1 per cent - but AI and machine-learning roles grew about 20 per cent, and fresher hiring inside AI/ML grew about 19 per cent in the same month. In plain terms: the average fresher opening is flat, and the AI-adjacent opening is the fastest-growing slice. A student who can show they study and work with AI is signalling a skill the market is actively paying for.

So why does this book exist?

Because access is not the same as ability. Hand a student a world-class assistant and, left alone, they will use it to produce answers - which teaches them nothing. The difference between a student who gains two grades and a student who loses two is not which tool they downloaded. It is the workflow they built around it. This book is that workflow, written for the Indian syllabus, the Indian exam, and the Indian budget of zero rupees.

The bottom line

The tools are free, official and already here. The advantage now belongs to the student who uses them to practise and recall - not to the student who uses them to avoid thinking. The rest of Part 1 explains exactly how to be the first student.

2. The one rule that decides everything

If you remember one sentence from this book, make it this: AI should produce the practice, and you should produce the answers. Every technique that follows is a variation on that rule.

The outsourcing trap

There are two ways to use an AI assistant on a difficult chapter. In the first, you paste the chapter, ask for a summary, read the summary and feel like you understood it. In the second, you paste the chapter, ask for ten questions that could be asked on it, answer them from memory, get the ones you missed explained, and answer those again tomorrow. The first feels productive and teaches almost nothing. The second feels like effort and is exactly what builds memory.

The trap is that the first approach gives you the pleasant sensation of fluency - the material looks familiar, so your brain files it as known. Cognitive scientists call the gap between that feeling and real recall the illusion of fluency. Reading a good summary produces the illusion; answering questions destroys it. AI is extraordinarily good at producing summaries. That is precisely why you must not let it do only that.

The explain-it-back test

After any AI study session, close the tool and explain the topic out loud, in your own words, as if teaching a classmate who missed it. If you can do that without peeking, you learned something. If you stall, the session was consumption, not study. Run this test every time until it becomes a reflex.

The decision rule

Before you type a request, ask one question: who is doing the thing I will be tested on? If the exam tests whether you can solve a problem, write an answer, or recall a fact, then you - not the AI - must produce that thing during practice. AI may set the problem, mark your attempt, and explain your mistakes. The moment it produces the answer you were meant to produce, the session has stopped being study.

Two green lights, one red light

Green: AI generates questions, marks your answers, explains your errors, and schedules your revision. Red: AI writes the essay, solves the sum, or drafts the answer you will submit as your own. Green builds skill; red builds a habit that collapses in the exam hall - and, as Chapter 4 explains, can get you penalised.

3. What the science actually says

You do not have to take the last chapter on faith. The most effective study techniques have been measured for decades, and the findings are unusually clear. The good news: the two techniques that win are exactly the ones AI makes fast.

The landmark review

In 2013 a team led by John Dunlosky published a monograph in *Psychological Science in the Public Interest* reviewing ten popular learning techniques and grading each one high, moderate or low for how well it works across ages, subjects and tests. Two techniques received the top grade. Practice testing - self-testing or taking practice tests over the material - and distributed practice - spreading study out over time instead of cramming - were rated high utility because they helped learners of different ages and abilities and improved performance across many kinds of tasks. Three more - elaborative interrogation, self-explanation and interleaved practice - earned a moderate rating. And five familiar favourites were rated low: summarisation, highlighting, the keyword mnemonic, imagery for text, and rereading.

Read that last sentence again. Rereading and highlighting - the two things most students do most of the time - were the least effective. The review is blunt about why: they do not consistently boost performance, so other techniques should be used in their place. Practice testing instead of rereading, in

the authors' own words.

Technique	Utility	How AI helps (or doesn't)
Practice testing	High	Generate exam-format questions from your own chapters; mark your answers instantly.
Distributed practice	High	Build a spaced review schedule and remind you what is due today.
Self-explanation	Moderate	Ask you to explain a concept back, then point out the gaps in your explanation.
Elaborative interrogation	Moderate	Push you to answer 'why is this true?' against the source.
Interleaved practice	Moderate	Mix problems from different chapters into one practice set.
Rereading	Low	Convenient but weak - do not make it your main method.
Highlighting	Low	Feels productive; the evidence does not support it as a primary method.

What this means in practice

You now have a filter for every AI study idea you will ever meet. If a technique makes you retrieve an answer from memory, or spreads your practice across days, it is worth your time. If it only helps you read or re-read information more comfortably, it is polish, not study. AI can do both - and it is dangerously good at the comfortable one. Aim it at retrieval and spacing, and you are using it against the strongest evidence we have.

The retrieval principle

Memory strengthens most when you pull information out, not when you put it in. Every time you answer a question from memory - even if you get it wrong, then correct it - you are doing the thing that research rates highest. Every time you re-read, you are doing the thing it rates lowest. AI lets you do the first at a scale that was never possible before.

4. Using AI without crossing the line

The rules around AI in Indian education are more settled than most students assume, and they almost all point the same way: using AI to learn is fine; passing off AI output as your own work is not. Knowing the difference protects your marks and your reputation.

The framework that already applies

The governing document in Indian higher education is the UGC (Promotion of Academic Integrity and Prevention of Plagiarism in Higher Educational Institutions) Regulations, 2018. Its definition of plagiarism is broad - it covers reproducing someone else's intellectual work without proper attribution - and AI-generated text that you submit without disclosure is not your intellectual work. In 2023 the UGC asked institutions to stay alert to AI-generated content in submissions and to build internal policies of their own. In other words, you do not need a new rule to be penalised for undisclosed AI text; the existing one already reaches it.

Where policy is heading

In July 2026 the Ministry of Education released voluntary guidelines on AI in education, covering curriculum, research ethics, assessment integrity and infrastructure, and asked universities to submit adoption plans. In September 2026 the UGC published a draft curriculum framework that would make a credited AI-literacy module compulsory for all first-year undergraduates from the 2027-28 session - teaching not just how to use generative tools but where they fail, and what campus conduct codes say about using them in assignments. Separately, the Ministry of Education's own framework groups its AI work under four headings - AI for school education, AI for higher education, AI for skilling and workforce readiness, and AI research - and AICTE has been pushing AI adoption across its affiliated institutions. The direction is unambiguous: AI literacy is becoming baseline, and disclosure is becoming the norm.

The green list and the red list

Almost always fine	Almost always a problem
Asking AI to explain a concept you did not understand	Submitting AI-written prose as your own
Generating practice questions and mock tests	Letting AI solve a problem you then present as your work
Getting feedback on a draft you wrote yourself	Using AI during a closed-book, no-AI assessment
Having AI quiz you and mark your recall	Fabricating citations or data that AI invented
Using AI to plan a revision schedule	Paraphrasing AI output to disguise it as original

Three habits that keep you safe

- 1 Disclose, briefly. If a submission involved AI in any way, say how - "AI used to check grammar and generate practice questions" is enough. Transparency is what the rules reward; concealment is what they punish.
- 2 Read your own institution's policy first. Rules vary by university and even by department. Do not rely on what a classmate says the rule is.
- 3 Keep AI out of the final artefact. Use it to prepare, practise and check - then write the submission yourself, in your own words, from your own understanding.

The one-line rule

Use AI to get better at the exam. Never let AI be the thing that takes the exam for you. Everything in this book sits comfortably on the right side of that line.

PART 2

Your free AI study stack

Nine tools, decoded with their real free limits, and the order to use them in. Nothing here costs money to start.

In this part

- Gemini Notebook - the source-grounded study engine
- ChatGPT and Google Gemini on their free plans
- The free one-year student offer for India
- NCERT, DIKSHA, SWAYAM and the official Indian vault
- The supporting cast: Perplexity, Quizlet and more

5. Gemini Notebook: the best free study tool in 2026

If you set up only one tool from this book, make it this one. Gemini Notebook - the product Google renamed from NotebookLM in July 2026 - is the single best free study assistant available to an Indian student today, and the reason is a design choice that matters more than any feature list: it answers only from the documents you give it.

Why source-grounding is the whole point

A general chatbot answers from everything it was trained on, which is why it can invent a formula, misquote a date or make up a citation with total confidence. Gemini Notebook works differently. You upload your textbook chapter, your class notes, your previous-year papers. It reads those and answers from those, with inline citations pointing back to the exact passage. For exam study, where being wrong is expensive, this one property is worth more than a dozen clever features.

What you get for free

The free tier is called Gemini Notebook Standard. Sign up with any Gmail account at notebooklm.google - the old address still redirects. On the free plan you get up to 100 notebooks and up to 50 sources in each notebook, with a per-source ceiling of about 500,000 words or a 200 MB upload. Since 2 September 2026, Google has metered consumer accounts with a compute-based usage budget rather than fixed daily counts: your quota refreshes every five hours up to a weekly limit, and heavier requests use more of it. Google's older help page still lists the previous fixed allowances, so treat the table below as a guide and check Settings, then Usage, in your own account.

Free (Standard) limit	What it means for you
100 notebooks	One per subject, per semester, with room to spare.
50 sources per notebook	A full textbook plus notes and past-year papers, easily.
500,000 words / 200 MB per source	Any single chapter or book PDF fits.
Compute budget, refreshed every 5 hours up to a weekly cap	Plenty for daily study; heavy video or audio generation drains it faster.
Inline citations on every answer	You can always trace a claim back to your own page.

The features that actually earn their place

- **Practice quizzes and flashcards** generated only from your sources, with explanations for wrong answers - the practice-testing engine from Chapter 3.
- **Audio Overviews** - a podcast-style conversation between two AI hosts summarising your material. Useful for revision while travelling or doing chores.
- **Video Overviews and Mind Maps** - a narrated visual and a connection map of your sources, for the topics that are easier to see than to read.
- **Study Guides** with key terms and sample questions, and **Guided Learning**, which leads you through a topic with probing questions instead of handing over the answer.

Set it up in ten minutes

- 1 Sign in at notebooklm.google with your Gmail account.
- 2 Create one notebook per subject. Name it clearly - "Physics - Class 12".

- 3 Upload the official chapter PDF, your own class notes, and the last few years' question papers.
- 4 Ask for a set of practice questions in your exam's format, answer them from memory, then ask for explanations of the ones you missed.

Why this beats a generic chatbot for exams

A general chatbot is a brilliant tutor with a shaky memory. Gemini Notebook is a careful tutor who has read your exact textbook and shows you the page. For syllabus study, the second is what you want.

6. ChatGPT on the free plan

ChatGPT remains the most flexible free assistant, and its free tier is stronger than most students realise. It is not source-grounded like Gemini Notebook, so you use it for a different job: conversation, explanation and interrogation.

What the free tier gives you

According to OpenAI's own help centre, free users have access to the GPT-5.6 Luna model, unlimited everyday text chats subject to abuse-prevention safeguards, and a set of tools that includes web search for current information, data analysis, file and image uploads, image creation, access to GPTs, and a Library with 500 MB of storage. File uploads, data analysis, image generation and voice carry their own separate limits, and ChatGPT tells you when you hit one. Ads may appear in the free tier in some countries. The default model and limits change over time, so check the model picker in your account for the current picture.

The three jobs it does best

- **Explain, then re-explain.** "Explain photosynthesis to me as if I am 15, then again as if I am preparing for NEET." Two levels of the same idea, instantly.
- **Interrogate you.** "Ask me one question at a time on this chapter. Do not give the answer until I have tried. After ten questions, tell me my weakest area." This is practice testing with a tutor who never gets tired.
- **Generate practice in your exam's format.** "Write eight NEET-style MCQs on this topic with four options each and mark the correct one, then give a one-line reason for each answer."

Where it will let you down

Because it is not grounded in your sources, ChatGPT can state a confident wrong fact, especially in fast-moving subjects, regional syllabi and numerical work. Treat every number, date and citation it gives you as a claim to verify against your textbook. For anything that will appear in a scored answer, cross-check with Gemini Notebook or the official source. Use ChatGPT for the reasoning and the conversation; use a grounded tool for the facts.

The pairing that works

Let Gemini Notebook hold your facts - your textbooks, notes and papers, with citations. Let ChatGPT do the talking - explaining, quizzing and pushing you. When the two disagree, the source-grounded one is usually right, and your textbook is always the referee.

7. Google Gemini and the free student year

If you are a college student in India, the single most valuable free offer of the year is sitting unclaimed: a full year of a paid Google AI plan, at no cost, if you redeem it before 31 December 2026.

What the offer is

On 20 August 2026 Google announced, in an India-specific post, that eligible college students in India would get one year of Google AI Plus free of charge. The plan includes access to Gemini Omni, twice the Gemini usage limits available to non-AI subscribers, 400 GB of storage shared across Gmail, Drive and Photos, and expanded Gemini Notebook features such as audio and video summaries and quiz generation. The offer must be redeemed by 31 December 2026.

The small print that matters

Google's own student page is refreshingly blunt about the terms, and you should read them before you click. The offer is for eligible students aged 18 and over, enrolled at a higher-education institution in a supported market, and your student status must be verified - often through a college email or an identity-verification service. You must add a valid payment method at sign-up. And unless you cancel earlier, the plan automatically converts to a paid subscription when the free year ends; Google's India page states that AI Plus will charge Rs 399 per month after the trial. Google is also offering a discounted bundle of Google AI Pro and YouTube Premium at up to 70 per cent off in eligible markets, on separate terms.

How to claim it without getting caught out

- 1 Go to the official Gemini student hub (gemini.google, the students page) - not a link from a random message.
- 2 Verify your student status with your college email or the verification service Google asks for.
- 3 Add a payment method, claim the year, then immediately set a calendar reminder for about eleven months from now.
- 4 At that reminder, decide whether to keep the plan at Rs 399 a month or cancel. Cancelling is available any time before the trial ends.

What to actually use it for

The extra headroom is worth most on three things: unlimited uploads into study notebooks, the higher Gemini usage limits for long study conversations, and the larger storage for storing your notes and past papers. If you are not a college student, do not worry - the free Standard tier of Gemini Notebook and the free ChatGPT plan covered in the last two chapters carry the same core study loop at zero cost.

Set the reminder now

The offer is genuinely valuable and genuinely easy to forget. The one action that turns it from a trap into a gift is a calendar alert eleven months out. Do that the day you claim it.

8. India's own free learning vault

The best sources for an Indian student are not AI at all - they are the official platforms the government has been building for years. AI becomes powerful the moment you feed these into it. Here is the vault, and how to combine it.

Platform	What it is	Use it for
NCERT and ePathshala	Official NCERT textbooks for Classes 1-12, free, as chapter-wise PDFs in English, Hindi and Urdu, plus audio and video resources.	The authoritative text to upload into your notebook.
DIKSHA	The national school-education platform, aligned to NCERT, CBSE, NIOS and state boards, with QR-coded Energised Textbooks and an AskDIKSHA feature.	Chapter-linked videos, interactives and quick concept checks.
SWAYAM	Free MOOCs from top institutions. NCERT is the national coordinator for school-level courses in Classes 9-12.	Structured courses with lectures, reading, tests and discussion forums.
NPTEL	IIT and IISc lecture courses, via SWAYAM.	College-level depth in engineering, science and the humanities.
PM eVIDYA DTH-TV	One Class, One Channel television delivery for Classes 1-12, linked to DIKSHA by QR code.	Revision when internet is limited.

Why this vault matters more than any single app

The scale is hard to overstate. SWAYAM, launched with IIT Madras, had developed more than 4,400 unique courses across ten national coordinators as of January 2026, with cumulative enrolments of roughly 5.80 crore learners and about 52.88 lakh certifications awarded, according to a Press Information Bureau release. ePathshala carries over 500 eTextbooks and nearly 3,900 e-resources, free. DIKSHA supports 36 Indian languages and has been adopted by almost every state and union territory. This is a library most students never open, sitting one search away.

The combination that turns free into fast

- 1 Download the official chapter PDF from NCERT or ePathshala. Free, and it is the exact text your exam is set from.
- 2 Upload it into the matching Gemini Notebook, along with your class notes and the last three years' question papers.
- 3 Ask for practice questions in your exam's format and answer them from memory.
- 4 Where a concept still does not click, watch the DIKSHA or SWAYAM video on the same chapter, then re-quiz yourself.

The source ladder

Put the official source at the top of your notebook, your own notes next, and past papers last. When the AI answers, it will lean on what you gave it. Feed it the best material and its answers get better; feed it random PDFs and you get random answers.

9. The supporting cast

Four or five more free tools round out the stack. None is essential, and all of them are worth knowing. Free tiers change often, so check each tool's own pricing page before you rely on a specific limit.

- **Perplexity** - a search assistant that answers questions and shows the web pages it used. Reach for it when you need current, sourced information rather than textbook facts, and read the sources it lists.

- **Quizlet** - flashcards and practice quizzes with spaced repetition. A good home for the recall sets you generate elsewhere.
- **Grammarly** - grammar and clarity checking for written assignments. Use it on your own writing, never as the writer.
- **Wolfram Alpha** - a computation engine that shows worked steps for maths and science problems. The honest cross-check when a language model gives you a suspicious number.
- **Anki** - the classic spaced-repetition app, free on desktop and Android. Powerful if you enjoy building your own decks; skip it if you will not maintain them.

How to choose, in one line

Grounding beats fluency, and a tool you will actually open beats a better tool you will not. If you are unsure, default to Gemini Notebook for facts and ChatGPT for conversation, and add the others only when you hit a specific wall.

Do not collect tools

The fastest way to waste a month is to spend it comparing apps. Pick the two core tools, run the loop in Chapter 10 for a week, and only then ask whether a third tool would genuinely help. Most students never need one.

PART 3

The system

The operating manual. A four-step loop, the notebook setup that makes it work, a prompt formula that stops the AI from misleading you, and a playbook for every major subject.

In this part

- The four-step AI study loop
- One notebook per subject
- The five-part prompt formula
- Subject playbooks: maths, science, language, humanities, code

10. The four-step AI study loop

Every good AI study session has the same shape, whether it lasts ten minutes or three hours. Learn the four steps once and you can run them on any subject, any tool, any day.

Step	What happens	Who does the work
1. Capture	Gather the right sources: the official chapter, your notes, past papers. Upload them into one notebook.	You
2. Understand	Ask for an explanation at your level, then a harder one. Ask 'why' until it is clear.	AI explains, you question
3. Recall	Generate flashcards and questions from the sources. Answer them from memory, without looking.	You - this is the step that builds memory
4. Test	Take a timed practice test in your exam's exact format. Review every wrong answer and re-test those topics tomorrow.	You answer, AI marks

Why the order matters

Steps 1 and 2 are preparation; steps 3 and 4 are where learning happens. Most students spend all their time in steps 1 and 2 - reading, watching, summarising - and feel busy while learning little. The loop forces you into 3 and 4, the retrieval steps that research rates highest, within every session.

A ninety-minute session, mapped

- 0-10 min: capture. Upload the chapter and skim your notes to remind yourself what the topic covers.
- 10-30 min: understand. Ask for a clear explanation, then a harder one, and interrogate anything that still feels slippery.
- 30-60 min: recall. Generate 20 questions or flashcards, and answer them from memory. Mark the ones you miss.
- 60-85 min: test. Sit a timed set in your exam's format. Do not pause to look things up.
- 85-90 min: close the loop. Ask the AI to explain only your wrong answers, and schedule those topics for tomorrow's recall.

The rule inside the loop

Never end a session in step 1 or 2. A session that stops at a summary has taught you almost nothing. A session that ends with you answering questions and reviewing your errors has done the work.

11. One notebook per subject

The quality of what an AI study tool gives you is set almost entirely by what you put into it. Set up your notebooks properly once and every later session gets faster.

The source ladder

Inside each subject notebook, keep three layers of sources, best at the top. The official textbook chapter (from NCERT or your board) is the referee - the AI should treat it as the truth. Your own class notes capture what your teacher emphasised and what your exam will weight. Past-year question papers tell the AI exactly what shape of question you face. When you ask for practice, name the layer you want it to draw from.

Setup, step by step

- 1 Create one notebook per subject, named for the subject and the term - "Biology - Class 12".
- 2 Upload the official chapter PDF first. This becomes the anchor source.
- 3 Add your own notes for the same chapter.
- 4 Add the last two or three years' question papers for the subject.
- 5 Keep it clean: delete sources for chapters you have finished and moved past, so answers stay focused on what you are studying now.

Three habits that keep notebooks sharp

- **One topic at a time.** A notebook that mixes ten chapters gives muddled answers. If a subject is large, make one notebook per unit.
- **Name your sources.** Rename uploads clearly - "Ch7 Respiration - NCERT" - so citations are easy to follow.
- **Re-upload fresh notes.** The value of the tool rises with the quality of what is inside it. Last year's messy scan is worth less than this week's clean notes.

A worked example

For a Class 12 Physics notebook: upload "Ch1 Electric Charges and Fields - NCERT", your teacher's derivations, and the last three years' board questions on the same chapter. Now when you ask for a test, you can say "using only the board questions in this notebook, write a ten-mark numerical set" - and get practice that matches your actual paper.

12. How to write study prompts that don't lie to you

A vague prompt gets a vague answer, and a vague answer is where AI study goes wrong. One five-part formula fixes it, and four guardrails keep the answers honest.

The RSTFG formula

Part	What to include	Example
Role	Tell it who to be.	"Act as a strict NEET examiner."
Source	Tell it what to use.	"Using only the sources in this notebook..."
Task	Say exactly what to do.	"...write eight single-correct MCQs on respiration."
Format	Say how to present it.	"Four options each, correct answer marked, one-line reason."
Guardrail	Say what to do when unsure.	"If something is not in the sources, say so instead of guessing."

Four guardrails that stop hallucinations

- 1 Anchor to the source. Start with "Using only the material in this notebook..." so the answer is grounded.
- 2 Demand citations. Ask for the page or passage behind each factual claim. If it cannot cite, treat the claim as unverified.

- 3 Give it an escape hatch. Add "If it is not in the sources, say 'not covered'." This alone removes most invented facts.
- 4 Verify numbers separately. For any figure that will be scored, cross-check with your textbook or a computation tool.

Bad prompt versus good prompt

Weak

"Explain the French Revolution." - You get a broad, confident, generic essay that may contain errors and is not tied to your syllabus.

Strong

"Using only the sources in this notebook, act as a CBSE Class 9 history teacher. Explain the three main causes of the French Revolution in under 150 words, at the level of a Class 9 student, with one example for each cause. Cite the passage you drew from. If a cause is not covered in the sources, say 'not covered'." - Same topic, but grounded, exam-shaped, and safe.

One reusable master prompt

PROMPT M - The master study prompt

Using only the sources in this notebook, act as a [exam] examiner. Topic: [topic]. First give me a 120-word explanation at my level. Then write [n] questions in the exact format of my exam. Mark the correct answers with a one-line reason each. If a fact is not in the sources, say 'not covered'. Finally, tell me the two sub-topics I am most likely to lose marks on.

Use it when: you want to convert any chapter into a complete study session in one paste.

13. Subject playbooks

The loop is universal; the tactics differ by subject. Here is how to aim the same tools at the five kinds of subject you will meet.

Maths and Physics - practise, then check the steps

- Ask for problems, not solutions: "Give me six problems on this chapter at board level, hardest last. Do not show the answers yet."
- Solve on paper first, then ask the AI to mark your working line by line and name the step where you went wrong.
- Cross-check any numeric answer with a computation tool. Language models make arithmetic slips; they are excellent at method, less reliable at sums.

Chemistry and Biology - mechanisms, diagrams and NCERT lines

- Ask for mechanisms and processes as numbered steps, then draw the diagram yourself and ask the AI to check your labels against the source.
- For biology, insist on NCERT wording. Say "quote the exact NCERT line that defines this" - competitive exams reward the textbook's phrasing.
- Turn every process into a sequence question: "Ask me to put the steps of glycolysis in order, one step at a time."

English and languages - feedback on your writing, not writing for you

- Write the paragraph yourself, then ask: "List my three biggest grammar errors and one way to make this clearer. Do not rewrite it for me."
- For vocabulary, ask for a short set of sentences using new words in your own exam's style, then write fresh sentences and have them checked.
- For spoken practice, use a voice conversation: "Have a two-minute conversation with me about my favourite subject, then correct my three most common mistakes."

Social sciences and humanities - timelines, causes and essay frames

- Ask for a dated timeline of a period, then quiz yourself on the order without looking.
- Ask "what were the three most important causes, and which one mattered most?" - then argue the opposite and see whether your reasoning holds.
- For long answers, ask for a skeleton - introduction, three body points, conclusion - then fill it in yourself from memory.

Coding and computer science - explain, debug, practise

- Ask the AI to explain an error message and the concept behind it, then fix the code yourself.
- Request small problems that build one concept at a time, and check your own solution before revealing the reference answer.
- For theory papers, generate definition and difference questions - the staple of board and university CS exams.

The common thread

In every subject, the AI sets the question and marks the attempt; you produce the answer. Change the subject, keep the rule.

PART 4

Exams

How to point everything you have learned at the exam itself - boards, competitive entrances, the last week, and the answers you write.

In this part

- The board-exam revision system
- JEE, NEET, CUET, UPSC and banking
- The final week and exam morning
- Writing better answers with AI

14. Boards: the AI-assisted revision system

Board exams are the most predictable papers you will ever sit. The syllabus is public, the paper pattern is public, and the marking scheme is public. That predictability is exactly what AI is best at exploiting.

Build the board kit

- 1 Download the official syllabus for your subject and board, and the latest sample or specimen paper.
- 2 Upload both, plus your NCERT or board textbook chapters, into a per-subject notebook.
- 3 Ask for the weightage: "Using the syllabus in this notebook, list the chapters by the marks they usually carry, highest first." Revise in that order, not front to back.

The three board skills AI sharpens

- **Recall of definitions and facts.** Generate flashcard-style questions and answer them daily. Board papers reward precise, textbook-accurate wording.
- **Numericals and structured problems.** Practise timed sets and have the AI mark your steps, not just the final answer.
- **Long answers and essays.** Ask for the marking scheme's structure - what examiners award marks for - then write to that structure yourself.

A weekly board routine

Each week, pick the two highest-weightage chapters you have covered. Run the four-step loop on them, then finish with a timed section from a past paper. Keep a running list of the topics you got wrong; that list, not the textbook, is what you revise in the last fortnight. Board toppers do not revise everything - they revise their own error list.

The marking-scheme trick

Ask the AI to act as a board examiner and mark your answer strictly against the official marking scheme. Then ask a second question: "What did I write that would earn no marks?" That second question teaches more than the first.

15. Competitive exams: JEE, NEET, CUET, UPSC, banking

Competitive exams reward a different skill from boards: speed, accuracy under negative marking, and the ability to read a question the way the setter intended. AI helps most with the last of those.

JEE and NEET - the numbers game

- Ask for timed sets in the exact pattern - correct question count, correct marking, correct negative marking - so your practice mirrors the real thing.
- After each set, ask: "Which questions did I get wrong because of a concept gap, and which because of a silly mistake? Separate them." The two need different fixes.
- For NEET, drill NCERT lines: "Quote the exact NCERT sentence behind each of these five statements." For JEE, drill speed on standard problem types and keep an error log.

CUET - breadth over depth

- CUET rewards coverage. Use AI to build a one-page summary per chapter, then test yourself on the summary.
- For the General Aptitude component, generate short timed sets on reasoning, quantitative and current-affairs-style questions.

UPSC - the reasoning and the current affairs

- For Prelims, use AI to build elimination-based practice: "Give me five statements on this topic and ask me which are correct - the way UPSC frames them."
- For Mains, use AI for structure, not content: ask for the skeleton of a 250-word answer, then write it from your own knowledge and reading.
- For current affairs, use a cited search tool like Perplexity and always read the sources it lists - do not accept an unsourced summary.

Banking and SSC - speed and pattern

- Generate sectional timed sets for reasoning, quantitative aptitude, English and general awareness.
- Ask the AI to explain, after each mock, the fastest safe method for the questions you left blank.

The one metric that matters

Track your accuracy and your time separately. Most aspirants improve accuracy and never fix speed, or chase speed and wreck accuracy. Ask the AI to report both after every set, and watch the pair move together.

16. The final week and exam morning

The last seven days are not for new learning. They are for recall, timing and calm. AI is a superb assistant for all three - if you use it to test, not to cram.

The seven-day taper

- 1 Days 7 to 5: revise your own error list only. Generate questions on exactly those topics and answer them from memory.
- 2 Days 4 to 2: one full timed mock a day, in exam conditions, at the exam's time of day. Review wrong answers the same evening.
- 3 Day 1: no new topics. Light recall of formulae and key definitions, then rest. Prepare your documents and stationery.
- 4 Exam morning: one short recall warm-up, nothing heavy, then stop and get to the centre early.

What to do with AI on the last day

- Ask for a five-minute rapid-fire quiz on formulae or definitions, and answer out loud.
- Ask the AI to list the five most common careless mistakes on your paper's pattern - then commit them to memory as a checklist.
- Do not ask it to explain anything new. New information on the last day adds anxiety, not marks.

Exam morning script

"Using only my notes in this notebook, give me ten rapid-fire one-line questions on the topics I marked as weak. No explanations until I answer." Answer them, breathe, close the app, and go. The work is done; the morning is for confidence, not coverage.

17. Better answers and essays with AI

The difference between a pass and a distinction is often not what you know but how you present it. AI is a patient, tireless coach for the presentation - as long as it coaches and you write.

The feedback loop that keeps your voice

- 1 Write the answer yourself, from memory, with no AI open.
- 2 Ask the AI to mark it against the marking scheme and to list, separately, what would earn marks and what would not.
- 3 Rewrite it yourself, fixing the gaps it named.
- 4 Repeat once. Two passes is usually enough to lift a good answer to a strong one.

The three things examiners reward

- **Structure.** A clear opening, ordered points, a closing line. Ask the AI to check only the structure of your answer and leave the content alone.
- **Evidence and example.** One concrete fact, date or example per major point. Ask the AI to flag any point where you asserted without evidence.
- **Precision.** Correct terminology and no filler. Ask the AI to cut your answer by 20 per cent without losing meaning - then do the cut yourself.

Keep it yours

An answer that reads like you, but is tighter and better organised, scores well and is safe. An answer that reads like a chatbot scores poorly and may be flagged. Use AI as the editor; stay the author.

PART 5

Prompt library and plan

Sixty-eight copy-paste prompts across ten categories, a thirty-day plan to build the habit, and the mistakes to avoid.

In this part

- How to use the library
- 68 prompts, ready to paste
- The 30-day adoption plan
- Nine mistakes and their fixes
- Frequently asked questions

18. How to use the library

These prompts are starting points, not scripts to recite. Every one is written to be pasted in under a minute and edited in seconds.

- 1 Replace the bracketed parts - [topic], [exam], [n] - with your own details. That is what makes a generic prompt work for your paper.
- 2 Paste into whichever tool suits the job. Use Gemini Notebook when the prompt says "in this notebook"; use ChatGPT or Gemini for conversation prompts.
- 3 Keep the guardrail. The line about saying "not covered" is what keeps the answers honest - leave it in.
- 4 Test the output. If a prompt returns something wrong, sharpen the source or add a format instruction. Prompts improve with one small edit, not a rewrite.

The three you will use most

If you read nothing else in this library, take prompt 15 (the explain-and-quiz loop), prompt 21 (the exam-format test), and prompt 55 (the answer marker). Those three cover the majority of a normal study week.

19. The library: 68 prompts

Organised by what you are trying to do. Numbers run continuously across categories.

A. Turn a chapter into notes and summaries

PROMPT 1 - Turn a chapter into a one-page map

Using only the sources in this notebook, turn [chapter] into a one-page structured outline: main headings, three to five bullets under each, and one line at the end naming the single most examinable idea. Cite the passages you used.

Use it when: you first open a new chapter and want the shape of it before you read.

PROMPT 2 - The 80/20 of a chapter

From the sources in this notebook, tell me the 20 per cent of [chapter] that carries 80 per cent of the marks, and explain why in one line each.

Use it when: you are short on time and need to triage.

PROMPT 3 - Build a glossary

List every key term in [chapter] with a one-line definition in the exact wording of the source, then flag the five terms most likely to be asked as one-mark definitions.

Use it when: you want precise, textbook-accurate language.

PROMPT 4 - Summarise to three lengths

Summarise [chapter] in 200 words, then 80 words, then 20 words. Keep the facts identical across all three; only the compression changes.

Use it when: you want to test what is truly essential.

PROMPT 5 - Make a comparison table

From the sources, build a table comparing [A] and [B] across the four features my exam usually tests. Use the source's own wording.

Use it when: a topic is taught as a contrast and you keep mixing the two up.

PROMPT 6 - Extract the formulae and laws

List every formula, law or rule in [chapter] with the symbol meanings and the conditions under which it applies. Flag any I am likely to misapply.

Use it when: you are preparing a formula sheet for revision.

PROMPT 7 - The 'what I still do not get' summary

Here is my own summary of [chapter]: [paste it]. Do not correct the grammar. Tell me only what is missing or wrong compared with the sources, and ask me one question to fix each gap.

Use it when: you have written your own notes and want them checked.

B. Understand a hard concept**PROMPT 8 - Explain at two levels**

Explain [concept] first as if I am 15, then again at exam level with correct terminology. Keep both explanations under 150 words.

Use it when: a concept will not stick after a plain reading.

PROMPT 9 - The why-chain

Explain [concept] by answering 'why' three times in a row, each answer building on the last, until I reach the underlying principle.

Use it when: you can state a fact but not explain it.

PROMPT 10 - Analogy then correction

Give me a simple everyday analogy for [concept]. Then tell me where the analogy breaks down, so I do not carry a wrong intuition into the exam.

Use it when: you learn faster from comparisons.

PROMPT 11 - Connect to what I already know

I already understand [concept A]. Explain [concept B] by showing exactly how it connects to A.

Use it when: you want to hang new knowledge on old.

PROMPT 12 - The worked example

Show one fully worked example of [type of problem] step by step, then give me two similar problems to try with no solution shown.

Use it when: you need a model before you practise.

PROMPT 13 - Find my misconception

Here is my current understanding of [concept]: [write it]. Tell me precisely which part is wrong or incomplete, and why a student often makes that exact error.

Use it when: you keep getting a topic wrong and do not know why.

PROMPT 14 - Diagram in words

Describe [process or structure] as a numbered sequence a student could draw from the description alone. Then list the three labels examiners most often see missed.

Use it when: the topic is visual and you cannot picture it.

PROMPT 15 - Simplify the language

Rewrite [hard passage] in plain English without losing any technical meaning. Keep every number and name intact.

Use it when: dense textbook prose is slowing you down.

C. Build active recall and flashcards**PROMPT 16 - The explain-and-quiz loop**

Using only the sources in this notebook, quiz me on [topic] one question at a time. Wait for my answer before revealing anything. After ten questions, tell me my two weakest sub-topics.

Use it when: you want a full recall session with a patient tutor.

PROMPT 17 - Auto-generate flashcards

From the sources in this notebook, create 20 flashcards on [topic] in question-answer pairs, hardest last. Keep each answer to one or two lines.

Use it when: you want a deck you can run daily.

PROMPT 18 - Cloze deletions

Turn these five key statements into fill-in-the-blank sentences with the crucial term removed. Give the answers separately.

Use it when: you want a quick, self-marking recall drill.

PROMPT 19 - Definition drill

Ask me for the exact definition of each key term in [chapter], one at a time. Mark each against the source wording and tell me where my wording is loose.

Use it when: precision of language costs you marks.

PROMPT 20 - Order and sequence

Give me the steps of [process] in scrambled order and ask me to put them right, one step at a time.

Use it when: a process has a fixed order you keep fumbling.

PROMPT 21 - The daily five

Give me five recall questions mixing the last three chapters I studied. One line each. No explanations until I answer.

Use it when: you want a two-minute warm-up each day.

PROMPT 22 - Teach it back

I will explain [topic] to you in my own words. Do not interrupt. Then tell me what I got right, what I missed, and what I got wrong.

Use it when: you want to prove to yourself that it stuck.

PROMPT 23 - Weak-spot recycling

Here are the questions I got wrong this week: [list]. Ask me only those again, in a different order, tomorrow's version.

Use it when: you want spaced repetition aimed at your own errors.

D. Generate practice tests and mocks**PROMPT 24 - The exam-format test**

Using only the sources in this notebook, write [n] questions on [topic] in the exact format of [exam], with correct marking and negative marking. Do not show answers until I ask.

Use it when: you want practice that mirrors the real paper.

PROMPT 25 - The full mock

Create a full-length practice paper on [subject] in the [exam] pattern, with the correct number of questions and time limit. Give a separate answer key.

Use it when: you are ready for a timed, whole-paper test.

PROMPT 26 - Sectional timed set

Give me a [n]-question sectional test on [topic] with a [x]-minute limit, in exam format.

Use it when: you want to train speed on one section.

PROMPT 27 - Hardest-first set

Give me ten questions on [topic], ordered from easy to hardest, so I can see where my understanding breaks.

Use it when: you want to find your ceiling on a topic.

PROMPT 28 - Trap questions

Write five questions on [topic] that look easy but contain a common trap. After I answer, explain the trap in each.

Use it when: you fall for 'silly mistakes' in the exam.

PROMPT 29 - Mark my mock

Here are my answers to this mock: [paste]. Mark them strictly against the marking scheme, list the ones I got wrong, and tell me the single concept behind each mistake.

Use it when: you have finished a test and want it graded honestly.

PROMPT 30 - Previous-year style

Using the past papers in this notebook, generate five new questions in the same style and difficulty, on topics they have not asked recently.

Use it when: you have exhausted the actual past papers.

PROMPT 31 - Rapid-fire round

Ask me 20 rapid-fire one-line questions on [subject]. I will answer each in a few words. Keep score and tell me my accuracy at the end.

Use it when: you want a fast, high-volume recall burst.

E. Solve doubts and check steps

PROMPT 32 - Mark my working

Here is my solution to this problem: [paste]. Do not give the answer. Point to the first line where my method goes wrong, and explain only that step.

Use it when: you got a problem wrong and want to find where.

PROMPT 33 - Hint ladder

I am stuck on this problem. Give me a hint, not the answer. If I am still stuck after trying, give a stronger hint, and only then the full solution.

Use it when: you want to struggle productively instead of peeking.

PROMPT 34 - Compare two methods

Solve this problem two ways and tell me which is faster and safer under exam conditions: [paste problem].

Use it when: you want to pick the right method before the exam.

PROMPT 35 - Check my reasoning, not my arithmetic

Read my reasoning for [problem]. Ignore small arithmetic slips. Tell me whether my logic is sound and where it would fail.

Use it when: you trust your maths but not your method.

PROMPT 36 - The 'what if' set

Take this problem and change one condition at a time, telling me how the answer changes and why. [paste problem]

Use it when: you want to understand a concept, not one problem.

PROMPT 37 - Teach the method

Teach me the standard method for [problem type] as a numbered checklist I can follow under time pressure.

Use it when: you keep forgetting the steps mid-problem.

F. Plan and space your revision**PROMPT 38 - Build a spaced schedule**

I have [n] days until [exam] and these topics: [list]. Build a revision schedule that spaces each topic across multiple days rather than cramming, and shows what to review each day.

Use it when: you want distributed practice instead of cramming.

PROMPT 39 - Today's list

Based on my schedule and what I got wrong yesterday: [list], tell me exactly what to study today, in order, with time estimates.

Use it when: you want to start the day without deciding.

PROMPT 40 - Weakest-first order

Rank these topics by how weak I am, based on this error list: [list]. Tell me which to attack first and why.

Use it when: you want to fix the biggest holes first.

PROMPT 41 - The weekly review

Here is everything I studied this week: [list]. Design a 45-minute review session that tests the most important parts, spaced for retention.

Use it when: you want to lock in a week's work.

PROMPT 42 - Backwards plan from exam day

Work backwards from [exam date] to today and tell me what must be finished by each week so I arrive prepared, with the final week left for revision only.

Use it when: you are starting a long preparation and need a map.

G. Get feedback on your writing and answers**PROMPT 43 - Mark my answer**

Here is my answer to [question]: [paste]. Mark it against the [exam] marking scheme. List what earns marks, what does not, and the one change that would gain the most.

Use it when: you have written an answer and want it graded.

PROMPT 44 - Structure check only

Look only at the structure of my answer: [paste]. Is the opening clear, are the points ordered, is there a closing line? Do not comment on content.

Use it when: your content is fine but your answers ramble.

PROMPT 45 - Cut without losing meaning

My answer is [n] words but the limit is [m]. Show me how to cut it to the limit without losing a single markable point.

Use it when: you always overrun the word limit.

PROMPT 46 - Evidence audit

Read my essay: [paste]. Flag every point where I asserted something without an example, date or fact, and suggest what evidence would strengthen it.

Use it when: your answers feel thin on support.

PROMPT 47 - Grammar and clarity pass

List my three most frequent grammar errors in this piece: [paste]. Give me one rule for each, and do not rewrite the piece for me.

Use it when: you want to improve your own writing, not borrow someone's.

PROMPT 48 - Model answer, then mine

Show me the ideal structure of an answer to [question] - points only, no prose. Then I will write it myself and you will mark it.

Use it when: you want a target before you write.

PROMPT 49 - Exam-style introduction bank

Give me three different ways to open an answer on [topic], each under 25 words, that sound like me and not like a textbook.

Use it when: your openings are weak and slow.

H. Learn a language faster**PROMPT 50 - Two-minute conversation**

Have a two-minute conversation with me in [language] about my daily routine. Keep it simple. Correct my three biggest mistakes at the end.

Use it when: you want speaking practice with no pressure.

PROMPT 51 - Vocabulary in context

Give me ten new [language] words for [theme], each in a simple sentence at my level, with the meaning in English.

Use it when: you want vocabulary that sticks through use.

PROMPT 52 - Grammar explained simply

Explain [grammar rule] in [language] in plain English with three examples, then give me five sentences to correct.

Use it when: a grammar rule keeps tripping you up.

PROMPT 53 - Shadowing script

Write a short paragraph in [language] at my level that I can read aloud to practise pronunciation and rhythm.

Use it when: you want spoken fluency, not just reading.

PROMPT 54 - Translation with feedback

I will translate these sentences into [language]. Mark them, explain each correction, and tell me the pattern in my mistakes.

Use it when: you want to turn errors into a lesson.

I. Exam-specific prompts**PROMPT 55 - Boards: weightage planner**

Using the syllabus in this notebook, list the chapters of [subject] by the marks they usually carry in the [board] exam, highest first, with one line on what each chapter rewards.

Use it when: you want to revise in order of marks, not page order.

PROMPT 56 - NEET: NCERT-line drill

Quote the exact NCERT line behind each of these statements and tell me which are true as written: [paste statements].

Use it when: NEET rewards textbook wording and you want to be exact.

PROMPT 57 - JEE: speed set

Give me a [n]-question set on [topic] in JEE pattern, and after I submit, tell me which questions I should have skipped for time.

Use it when: you are losing marks to time, not knowledge.

PROMPT 58 - UPSC Prelims: elimination drill

Write five UPSC-style statements on [topic] and ask me which are correct, the way the paper frames them. Then explain the elimination logic.

Use it when: Prelims rewards elimination under pressure.

PROMPT 59 - UPSC Mains: answer skeleton

Give me the skeleton of a 250-word UPSC Mains answer on [topic] - introduction, body points, conclusion - without writing the content. I will fill it in.

Use it when: you know the content but not the format.

PROMPT 60 - Banking: sectional strategy

For the [bank exam] [section], tell me the best order to attempt questions and the cut-off time per question for my accuracy level: [state it].

Use it when: you want a section strategy, not more practice.

PROMPT 61 - CUET: coverage map

List the [CUET] [subject] syllabus as a coverage map I can tick off, grouped so I can see what is left at a glance.

Use it when: CUET rewards breadth and you need a tracker.

PROMPT 62 - State PSC: regional weighting

For [state PSC], tell me which sections usually carry the most weight and which are the most ignored, based on the pattern in the past papers in this notebook.

Use it when: you want to target your state paper's quirks.

PROMPT 63 - Any exam: the top-10 checklist

From everything in this notebook, build the ten-point checklist of facts, formulae or definitions I must be able to recall cold on exam day for [subject].

Use it when: you want a single-page final-revision sheet.

J. Focus, motivation and study planning

PROMPT 64 - Break the wall

I have been stuck on [topic] for a while and cannot get going. Break it into five tiny, specific tasks I could each finish in ten minutes.

Use it when: a topic feels too big to start.

PROMPT 65 - Study plan from my hours

I can study [n] hours a day and have these subjects: [list]. Build a realistic daily timetable with breaks, and tell me what to do when I fall behind.

Use it when: you need a plan that survives real life.

PROMPT 66 - Beat procrastination

I keep postponing [task]. Ask me three questions to find the real reason, then give me one action to start in the next five minutes.

Use it when: you know what to do but are not doing it.

PROMPT 67 - End-of-day review

Here is what I did today: [list]. Tell me what I actually learned, what I only read, and the one thing I should recall before sleeping.

Use it when: you want to close the day with real retention.

PROMPT 68 - The weekly reset

Help me review my week: what worked, what I avoided, and one change to make next week. Ask me questions one at a time.

Use it when: you want a simple weekly habit check.

20. The 30-day adoption plan

Habits stick when they start small. This plan builds the system one week at a time - and by day 30 the loop is automatic.

Week	Focus	What you do
Week 1	One tool, one subject	Create a single Gemini Notebook for your weakest subject. Run the four-step loop three times this week. Nothing else.
Week 2	Add ChatGPT	Keep the notebook running. Add ChatGPT for explanation and interrogation, and use the explain-and-quiz loop daily.
Week 3	Add spacing	Build a spaced schedule with prompt 35. Start each day with the daily-five recall drill. Track your error list.
Week 4	Full exam mode	Run two timed mocks this week and mark them with prompt 26. Refine your prompt wording. Review the week with prompt 67.

The daily minimum

On a busy day, do not abandon the system - shrink it. Ten minutes is enough: five minutes of recall questions on yesterday's topic, five minutes reviewing the ones you missed. The habit matters more than the volume. A student who recalls ten questions a day beats a student who reads for three hours twice a week.

Track two numbers

Each day, note two things: how many recall questions you answered, and how many you got right. The first number is your effort; the second is your progress. Watch the second climb and you will not need motivation.

21. Nine mistakes and their fixes

These are the errors that quietly waste the most study time. Each comes with the fix.

- 1 Reading instead of recalling.** Summaries feel like progress but rank lowest in the research. Fix: end every session with questions you answer from memory.
- 2 Letting the AI produce the answer.** It removes the very effort that builds memory. Fix: AI sets and marks; you produce.
- 3 Trusting a chatbot's facts.** Ungrounded answers can be confidently wrong. Fix: anchor to a notebook and verify numbers.
- 4 Cramming.** Spacing beats massed practice, every time. Fix: spread each topic across days using a spaced schedule.
- 5 Collecting tools.** Comparing apps is not studying. Fix: two tools, one loop, one week before you consider a third.
- 6 Studying in page order.** Marks are not spread evenly. Fix: revise by weightage, highest first.
- 7 Ignoring your own error list.** The topics you got wrong are your real syllabus. Fix: re-test only those in the final fortnight.
- 8 Practising without a clock.** Competitive exams are a speed test as much as a knowledge test. Fix: timed sets from week one.
- 9 Submitting AI prose.** It risks penalties and teaches nothing. Fix: use AI to prepare, then write the submission yourself.

If you fix only one

Fix the first mistake. Replacing rereading with retrieval is the single highest-return change a student can make - and it is the change AI makes easiest.

22. Frequently asked questions

The questions students ask most, answered plainly.

Is any of this actually free?

Yes. Gemini Notebook Standard is free with any Gmail account, and ChatGPT's free tier covers the study loop in this book. The Google AI Plus year for college students is free to claim until 31 December 2026, but converts to Rs 399 a month after the trial unless you cancel. Everything in Parts 1 to 3 works at zero cost.

Do I need a laptop, or is a phone enough?

A phone is enough to start. Gemini Notebook and ChatGPT both work in a mobile browser and as apps. A laptop is more comfortable for long practice sets, but the loop works on the smallest screen.

Will AI make me lazy or dependent?

Only if you let it produce your answers. Used as this book describes - to generate practice, mark your attempts and explain your errors - it builds independence, because the work of retrieval stays with you. The explain-it-back test in Chapter 2 is your safeguard.

Can my teacher tell if I used AI?

Institutions increasingly run AI-detection alongside plagiarism checks, and undisclosed AI text can be treated as plagiarism under existing UGC regulations. The safe path is simple: use AI to prepare and practise, write submissions yourself, and disclose any AI help honestly.

What about subjects where AI is unreliable?

Numerical work is the main one - language models can slip on arithmetic. Use them for method and explanation, and cross-check numbers with a computation tool or your own working. For factual claims in fast-moving or regional syllabi, trust a source-grounded notebook over a general chatbot.

Which single tool should I start with?

Gemini Notebook. It is free, it answers from your own textbooks, and it generates the practice questions and flashcards that research rates highest. Add ChatGPT in week two.

How do I keep up when the tools change?

Assume every limit and price in this book will move. Re-check the tool's own help or pricing page when a number matters, and keep the workflow - capture, understand, recall, test - because the loop outlives any single app.

One last thing

The tools in this book will keep changing. The principle will not: memory is built by pulling answers out, not by putting information in. Build that habit, and every future tool becomes an upgrade to a system that already works.